Essay Outline Template

Plan before you write: organise ideas, evidence, and references

Essay Details

Item	Your notes
Essay title / question	
Subject / course	
Required word count	
Referencing style	
Deadline	

1. Understand the Question

Key instruction word: _____ Main topic: _____ Limits/scope: _____

2. Working Thesis Statement

My main argument or answer in one or two sentences:

_____

_____

3. Introduction Plan

Part	Notes
Hook / context	
Background information	
Thesis statement	
Roadmap of main points	

4. Body Paragraph Plan

Paragraph	Topic sentence / main point	Evidence or example	Explanation: how evidence supports the argument	Source / citation
1				
2				
3				
4 (optional)				

5. Conclusion Plan

Part	Notes
Restate answer / thesis in new words	
Summarise key points	
Final implication or recommendation	

Final Check

- ■ Every paragraph supports my thesis statement.
- ■ I used reliable sources and cited them correctly.
- ■ I paraphrased in my own words and quoted sparingly.
- ■ My introduction, body, and conclusion answer the question directly.
- ■ I checked grammar, spelling, formatting, and the reference list.

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